

Activating Rural America Workgroup

Physical Activity Research Center



Making physical activity an everyday experience for all children

Physical Activity Research Center



UC San Diego

Sponsor



Robert Wood Johnson Foundation



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PARC Core Research Studies

- Youth Physical Activity in Summer: Patterns and Disparities
- Youth Engagement and Action for Health!
- Promoting Safe Places to Play: Implementation of Play Streets in Diverse Low-Income Rural Communities
- Physical Activity and Recreation in Children in Communities of Color – PARC3



PARC Commissioned Study Projects

- Evaluating the California Distinguished After School Health Program- Supplemental Physical Activity Component
- Decision Making toward Successful Physical Activity Practices in Schools
- Effective School Investment in Physical Activity: Calibrating Costs and Benefits
- Evidence to Inform a Cycling and Walking Investment Strategy
- Best Practices in Engaging Public Health in Complete Streets Policy Actions



Voices for Healthy Kids



- Advocacy initiative with the goal of **reversing childhood obesity through policy change in disproportionately affected areas.**
- *Activating Rural America* is an Innovation, Equity and Exploration special project workgroup (IEE).
 - Designed to mobilize broad expertise, perspectives and advocacy capacity in an engagement model around health equity and the social determinants of health.
 - Goal: Advance the public policy agenda of the initiative.



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VFHK Policy Priorities - Schools

- **Healthy, Equitable Schools:** Promote the Whole School, Whole Community, Whole Child (WSCSS) model to support and build broad and inclusive healthy, school environments, particularly in marginalized or under-resourced communities. Work to support and build healthy schools for all children regardless of where they live or go to school. Specific policies include:
 - **Physical activity:** Support physical activity opportunities that promote active transportation policy such as safe routes to school programs, recess, classroom physical activity breaks and in other after school programs.



VFHK Policy Priorities - Active Travel

- **Active, Equitable Communities:** Support state and local policies and funding, and influence the use of federal dollars in states, that make communities and neighborhoods more livable by ensuring all people can get safely to where they need to go – work, school, the library, grocery stores, or parks, starting where the needs are greatest. Specific policies include:
 - **Complete streets:** Require that all road construction and reconstruction at the state, regional and community levels create complete streets that are safe and convenient for all users and all modes of transportation.
 - **Bike and pedestrian appropriations:** Support state, regional and local financing mechanisms that create equitable, long-term funding for bicycling and walking projects and encourage programs for communities most in need.



Welcome and Introductions

- Introductions
 - Name
 - Organization
 - Why are you looking forward to participating in this workgroup?
- Leadership Team
 - [Renée Umstattd Meyer](#), Principal Investigator, Baylor University
 - [Christiaan Abildso](#), Co-Investigator, West Virginia University
 - [Amanda Walker](#), Project Coordinator, UC San Diego
 - [Christina Bridges Hamilton](#), Project Staff, Baylor University
 - [Michelle Pennington](#), Project Staff, Baylor University



Introductions

- Voices for Healthy Kids Team
 - [NaDa Shoemaker](#), National Partnership Manager – Coalitions, Voices for Healthy Kids, American Heart Association
 - [Marla Hollander](#), National Partnership Manager, Voices for Healthy Kids, American Heart Association
 - [Claudia Goytia](#), State and Community Advocacy Manager, American Heart Association, Voices for Healthy Kids, American Heart Association
 - [Aaron Doeppers](#), Senior Manager of Strategic Partnerships, Voices for Healthy Kids, American Heart Association



Introductions

- Safe Routes to School
 - [Ashley Christensen](#), Regional Economic Development Specialist, Upper Explorerland Regional Planning Commission
 - [Hillary Mead](#), Supervisor, Cherokee Nation Public Health
 - [Jacki Schares](#), Safe Routes to School Coordinator, Iowa Northland Regional Council of Government (INRCOG)
 - [Jerry Stensland](#), President, Rutherford Outdoor Coalition, North Carolina



Introductions

- Complete Streets
 - [Ron Bentch](#), Project Coordinator, Missourians for Responsible Transportation
 - [Ross Daniels](#), AICP, Community Planner, Public Health Law Center
 - [Gregoria Ponce](#), Office Chief, Rural Planning, Caltrans
 - [Sandy Slater](#), Associate Professor, Concordia University-Wisconsin
- Bike and Pedestrian Appropriations
 - [Chris Clark](#), Grassroots Campaign Manager, Palmetto Cycling Coalition
 - [Cathy Costakis](#), Healthy Community Design Consultant



Introductions

- Community and Health Equity
 - [David Brown](#), Senior Behavioral Scientist, Centers for Disease Control and Prevention
 - [Beverly Collins-Hall](#), Executive Director, American Indian Mothers Inc.
 - [Leah Gagnon](#), Special Projects Coordinator, Missouri Council for Activity and Nutrition (MOCAN)
 - [Micah Holcombe](#), County Extension Agent, Texas A&M AgriLife Extension Service
 - [Megan McClendon](#), Lecturer, Public Health Program, Texas State University
 - [Nicole Miller](#), Library Director, Cannon Falls Library
 - [Yvonne Murphy](#), N.C. Cooperative Extension, Edgecombe County Center



Our Purpose

- Overall Goal

- To inform VFHK of rural practices and challenges regarding the active living-related policy levers, with specific attention to health equity.

- Workgroup

- Scan and synthesize policy and advocacy literature and web presence and survey and/or interview key decision makers of rural communities engaged in this work.
- 1-2 calls / month to accomplish project goal, produce the deliverables, and learn from guest speakers.

- Advisory board

- National advocacy organizations will provide a higher-level perspective, review and provide feedback on methods and materials, and assist with dissemination.



Deliverables

- **Identify and describe current rural efforts** to adapt and advance the VFHK active living policy levers, with specific attention to approaches or challenges related to **health equity** in rural communities.
- Provide recommendations and considerations to VFHK for **next steps in continuing or modifying policy levers for rural communities**.
- Create **summaries of lessons learned** from workgroup activities that could be distributed to a variety of stakeholders with interests in rural health and physical activity.
- **Develop a prioritized set of research questions** that could fill gaps in understanding and developing solutions for inequities in physical activity opportunities for rural youth.



Timeline

Timeframe	Objective
July – Sept 2019	Workgroup planning
Oct 2019	Invite workgroup members, advisory board members, and speakers; schedule workgroup and advisory board launch calls
Nov 2019	Hold first workgroup and advisory group calls
Nov 2019 - June 2020	Schedule 2-4 workgroup calls per month; hold quarterly advisory board calls; send out bi-monthly newsletters
Feb 2020	In-person meeting at the Active Living Conference for those in attendance
Jan – Apr 2020	Conduct interviews and surveys with rural community leaders and advocacy groups
Apr – June 2020	Develop a prioritized set of research questions for VFHK; provide recommendations and considerations to VFHK for next steps in continuing to modify active living policy levers for rural communities



Progress Update

- Grey literature search
- Google news scan
- We want your feedback!



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Grey Literature Search

Grey literature includes reports, government documents, evaluations, policies, newsletters, blogs, etc.



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Grey Literature Search

■ **Methods**

- Google Search terms:
 - “safe routes to school”
 - “complete streets”
 - “bicycle pedestrian appropriations” / “bicycle appropriations” / “pedestrian appropriations” / “bike/ped appropriations”
 - AND “rural”
 - AND *state name* (including the District of Columbia)
- Search included resources that were for or pertained to rural areas, or included sections/information for rural areas

■ **Results**

- Safe Routes to School: 30 resources
- Complete Streets & Bike/Ped Appropriations: 86 resources
 - Combined due to overlap



Grey Literature Search

- **Themes**

- Safe Routes to School
 - Remote drop off
 - Walking school bus
 - Walk to school day
 - Bike rodeo/rally
- Complete Streets & Bike/Ped Appropriations
 - Road improvements (paved shoulders, traffic calming measures, signage)
 - Policies



News Scan



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News Scan

- **Methods**

- Google News & Google News Archives
- Search terms:
 - “safe routes to school”
 - “complete streets”
 - “bicycle pedestrian appropriations” / “bicycle appropriations” / “pedestrian appropriations” / “bike/ped appropriations” / “bicycle improvements” / “pedestrian improvements”
- Inclusion criteria
 - Viewable (i.e. did not require subscription)
 - Pertained to rural communities in the US as determined using RUCA codes

News Scan

- **Results**

- Safe Routes to School: 37 articles
- Complete Streets: 11 articles
- Bike/Pedestrian Appropriations: 30 articles
 - Still searching additional bike/ped terms
 - E.g. search terms: funding, infrastructure



Next Steps

- Any suggestions on how to expand the scans?
- Please help identify communities for potential surveys / key informant interviews.
 - We will send a Google Form after our call today to collect your ideas.
 - Please tell us about any communities you know of, including your own!
- **Next Call:** December 4th, 1:00 pm EST
 - Please think about the types of questions we should ask to understand what rural communities are doing in these policy areas.